

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 8

Group 8 Vocabulary

1. Accentuate

Meaning: To emphasize or make something more noticeable.

Tip to remember: Think of an accent mark that makes part of a word stand out. Accentuate means to make something stand out.

Sentence: The dark background accentuated the brightness of the painting.

2. Conjectural

Meaning: Based on guesswork rather than solid evidence.

Tip to remember: Conjectural comes from conjecture, meaning a guess. So conjectural ideas are not proven.

Sentence: His explanation was only conjectural because he had no data.

3. Convivial

Meaning: Friendly, lively, and enjoyable.

Tip to remember: Think of a cheerful dinner with friends. That warm, social mood is convivial.

Sentence: The hostel had a convivial atmosphere.

4. Decadent

Meaning: Morally or culturally declining; excessively luxurious.

Tip to remember: Decadent sounds like decay. A decadent society is decaying because of too much luxury or corruption.

Sentence: The king lived a decadent life while his people suffered.

5. Egregious

Meaning: Extremely bad or shocking.

Tip to remember: Think of an error so bad that everyone notices it. That is egregious.

Sentence: The report contained an egregious calculation mistake.

6. Evanescent

Meaning: Disappearing quickly; lasting for a very short time.

Tip to remember: Evanescent sounds like “evaporate.” Something evanescent disappears like vapor.

Sentence: The beauty of the sunset was evanescent.

7. **Flamboyant**
Meaning: Bright, showy, and attention-grabbing.
Tip to remember: Think of flames: bright and noticeable. A flamboyant person or style stands out.
Sentence: He wore a flamboyant jacket to the party.
8. **Forestall**
Meaning: To prevent something by acting before it happens.
Tip to remember: “Fore” means before. Forestall means to stop something before it occurs.
Sentence: The government took steps to forestall an energy crisis.
9. **Gainsay**
Meaning: To deny, oppose, or contradict.
Tip to remember: Think of saying something “against” another statement. Gainsay means to speak against.
Sentence: No one could gainsay the evidence presented in court.
10. **Galvanize**
Meaning: To shock or excite someone into taking action.
Tip to remember: Galvanize originally relates to electric shock. A strong event can electrically shock people into action.
Sentence: The earthquake galvanized volunteers to help the victims.
11. **Indiscriminate**
Meaning: Done without careful choice or distinction.
Tip to remember: Discriminate means to distinguish. Indiscriminate means not distinguishing.
Sentence: Indiscriminate use of antibiotics can be harmful.
12. **Innocuous**
Meaning: Harmless; not likely to offend or hurt.
Tip to remember: Innocuous sounds like innocent. Innocent things are harmless.
Sentence: His comment seemed innocuous, but some people misunderstood it.
13. **Momentary**
Meaning: Lasting for a very short time.
Tip to remember: Momentary comes from moment. It lasts only for a moment.
Sentence: There was a momentary silence before the applause began.
14. **Mundane**
Meaning: Ordinary, boring, and not special.
Tip to remember: Think of daily routine tasks like washing dishes or waiting in line. These are mundane.
Sentence: He wanted adventure, not a mundane office job.
15. **Nettlesome**
Meaning: Annoying, irritating, or troublesome.

Tip to remember: Nettles are plants that sting. Nettlesome problems sting your mind and irritate you.

Sentence: The nettlesome software bug delayed the project.

16. **Nullify**

Meaning: To cancel, invalidate, or make ineffective.

Tip to remember: Null means zero. Nullify means to reduce something's effect to zero.

Sentence: One careless mistake can nullify hours of hard work.

17. **Obviate**

Meaning: To remove the need for something; to prevent.

Tip to remember: Think of making an obstacle vanish. Obviate means to make something unnecessary.

Sentence: Online submission obviates the need to print the form.

18. **Omnipresent**

Meaning: Present everywhere.

Tip to remember: "Omni" means all, and present means existing. Omnipresent means present in all places.

Sentence: Smartphones are almost omnipresent in modern life.

19. **Oust**

Meaning: To remove someone from a position or place.

Tip to remember: Oust sounds like "out." To oust someone is to force them out.

Sentence: The board voted to oust the corrupt manager.

20. **Palpable**

Meaning: So clear or strong that it can almost be felt.

Tip to remember: Palpable is related to touching. If tension is palpable, it feels almost touchable.

Sentence: The fear in the room was palpable.

21. **Perfidy**

Meaning: Betrayal or deliberate disloyalty.

Tip to remember: Think of a fake friend who breaks your trust perfectly badly. That is perfidy.

Sentence: The king punished the soldier for his perfidy.

22. **Profuse**

Meaning: Very abundant; given or produced in large amounts.

Tip to remember: Profuse sounds like "produce fully." Something profuse is produced in a large amount.

Sentence: He offered profuse apologies for being late.

23. **Pugnacious**

Meaning: Eager or quick to argue, fight, or quarrel.

Tip to remember: Think of a person always ready to punch. Pugnacious means fight-loving.

Sentence: His pugnacious attitude made teamwork difficult.

24. **Sagacious**

Meaning: Wise and showing good judgment.

Tip to remember: Sagacious sounds like sage, which means a wise person.

Sentence: The sagacious professor gave excellent career advice.

25. **Sanguine**

Meaning: Cheerfully optimistic or confident.

Tip to remember: Think of someone smiling even before a difficult exam because they believe things will go well.

Sentence: She remained sanguine about her chances of getting a scholarship.

26. **Scant**

Meaning: Very little; barely enough.

Tip to remember: Scant sounds like “can’t.” With scant resources, you can’t do much.

Sentence: The project failed because it received scant funding.

27. **Skullduggery**

Meaning: Dishonest, secret, or tricky behavior.

Tip to remember: Think of someone using their skull/brain for dirty tricks. That is skullduggery.

Sentence: The investigation exposed political skullduggery.

28. **Trivial**

Meaning: Unimportant or insignificant.

Tip to remember: Think of small issues that do not matter much. Those issues are trivial.

Sentence: They wasted the meeting discussing trivial matters.

29. **Utilitarian**

Meaning: Designed to be useful or practical rather than beautiful.

Tip to remember: Utilitarian comes from utility, meaning usefulness.

Sentence: The building had a plain but utilitarian design.

30. **Vapid**

Meaning: Dull, boring, or lacking flavor and life.

Tip to remember: Think of tea without sugar or flavor. It feels empty and vapid.

Sentence: The movie had beautiful visuals but a vapid story.